PICTURE AND ACTIVITY BOOKLET

Nursery English

First words through play



AGES 2 TO 3

10 familiar themes
Pictures, stories and hands-on activities

Prepared by: Ms. Amina Qatan

2026

MY FIRST ENGLISH

This is my book

This is me.

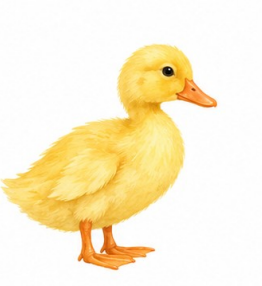
Draw or add a photograph

My name _____

Point to something you like.







I like _____

Together An adult may write the child's words. Looking, pointing, reaching and speaking all count.

TEN FAMILIAR THEMES

Our learning journey

Unit	Theme	Starts on
01	Hello and my needs	5
02	Me and my family	8
03	My body can move	11
04	My feelings	14
05	Colours and sizes	17
06	My toys	20
07	Food and drink	23
08	Animals around me	26
09	Getting ready	29
10	Nature around me	32

Look and listen

Explore a scene and hear useful first words.

Play and discover

Match, move, choose and try with real objects.

Story and make

Enjoy a short story and make your own marks.

Picture cards 35-38 | Teaching ideas 39-40
Answer guidance 41 | Observation record 42
Learning celebration 43 | Family guide 44

FOR THE ADULT

Learning together

This booklet introduces everyday English through warm conversation, play and familiar routines. An adult reads the words and instructions. The child may respond with a look, a gesture, an action or speech.

Begin with real things

Show a real object or action before its picture. Offer two choices, name them and wait. Ask the child to find one. Invite naming only when they are ready.

Keep each encounter short

Try one task for a few enjoyable minutes. Revisit it during the day. Select three to five focus words and one phrase for a week as a flexible starting point, then adjust to the child.

Let the child choose

Prepare two simple activities on a low shelf. Model how to carry, use and return the materials. Allow repetition and avoid interrupting sustained interest.

Make checking possible

Use an identical picture, a matching object or one space for each item. Help the child compare. Personal pictures, feelings and creative marks have no single correct answer.

Welcome every response

Use gestures and the child's home language to support understanding. Offer seated movements, larger pictures or extra time. Reading, spelling and letter tracing are not requirements.

Prepare safe materials

Use large objects and adult supervision. Adults prepare cut cards and keep loose pieces away from children who mouth objects. Use unbreakable cups, washable crayons and child-safe plants. Food tasting is optional.

Inspired by Montessori principles. Stories, chants and paper activities are enrichment. This is an original teaching resource, with no claim of official Montessori accreditation.

UNIT 01 LOOK AND LISTEN

Hello and my needs

Wave hello. Find the ball.





hello



ball



happy

Help, please.

Words to model hello, bye, help, more. Introduce a few at a time; labels are for shared talk.

UNIT 01 HELLO AND MY NEEDS

Play and discover

1 Wave hello. Wave goodbye.



hello



bye

2 Choose a toy.



ball



book

More, please. Help, please.

Together Greet a puppet. Offer a ball or book. Accept yes, no, a gesture or a look. Model a request when help is needed.

UNIT 01 AN ADULT READS ALOUD

Story and make



Hello, Al Zahraa!



A ball, please.



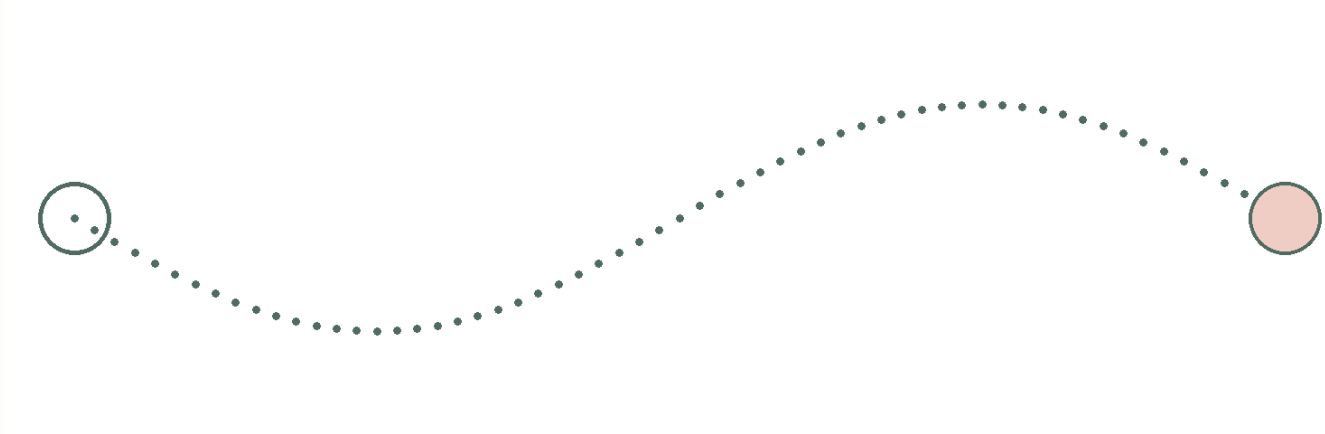
Here you are!

1 Find the ball.





2 Follow the path with your finger.



Chant together Hello, hello. Wave to me. / Hello, hello. One, two, three.

Make marks, point or use real objects. An adult may help. Stop while the activity is enjoyable.

UNIT 02 LOOK AND LISTEN

Me and my family

Look at the family photo.





family



girl



boy

This is me.

Words to model mummy, daddy, baby, family. Introduce a few at a time; labels are for shared talk.

UNIT 02 ME AND MY FAMILY

Play and discover

1 Find the same family.







2 Show someone who cares for you.

Add a photo or make a drawing together

Together Use the child's own family names. A child may choose not to share a personal photo.

UNIT 02 AN ADULT READS ALOUD

Story and make



This is Al Zahraa.



This is her family.



Hello, family!

1 Find the family.





2 Make a picture of your family.

Chant together Me and you. You and me. / Hello, lovely family.

Make marks, point or use real objects. An adult may help. Stop while the activity is enjoyable.

UNIT 03 LOOK AND LISTEN

My body can move

Look at the hands. Clap with me.





hand



clap



stand

Clap your hands.

Words to model hands, feet, clap, stop. Introduce a few at a time; labels are for shared talk.

UNIT 03 MY BODY CAN MOVE

Play and discover

1 Find your hands.



hand

Touch your nose. Touch your feet.

2 Watch. Clap. Stop.



clap



stop

Together Model one action at a time. Say stop and become still. Offer a comfortable seated action if preferred.

UNIT 03 AN ADULT READS ALOUD

Story and make



Look at Ahmad.



Clap, clap, clap.



Now stop.

1 Find the clapping hands.





2 Make hand marks or a hand outline.

Chant together Clap, clap. Tap, tap. / Stop and rest your hands.

Make marks, point or use real objects. An adult may help. Stop while the activity is enjoyable.

UNIT 04 LOOK AND LISTEN

My feelings

Look at Ahmad. He is tired.





happy



sad



tired

I need help.

Words to model happy, sad, tired, help. Introduce a few at a time; labels are for shared talk.

UNIT 04 MY FEELINGS

Play and discover

1 Find the same face.









2 Choose how you feel.



happy



sad



tired

Together Accept the child's choice. Do not mark a personal feeling right or wrong. Model I need help when the puppet needs a rest.

UNIT 04 AN ADULT READS ALOUD

Story and make



Ahmad is tired.



Al Zahraa helps.



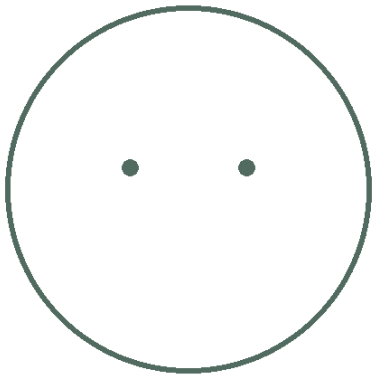
Rest, Ahmad.

1 Find the tired face.





2 Give the face a mouth.



Chant together A little rest. A gentle hand. / I can help. I understand.

Make marks, point or use real objects. An adult may help. Stop while the activity is enjoyable.

UNIT 05 LOOK AND LISTEN

Colours and sizes

Find red. Find blue. Find yellow.





ball



cup



hat

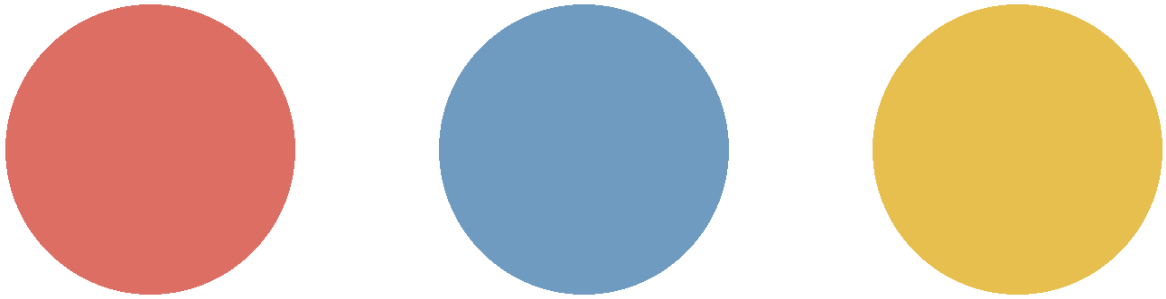
A red ball.

Words to model red, blue, yellow, big, small. Introduce a few at a time; labels are for shared talk.

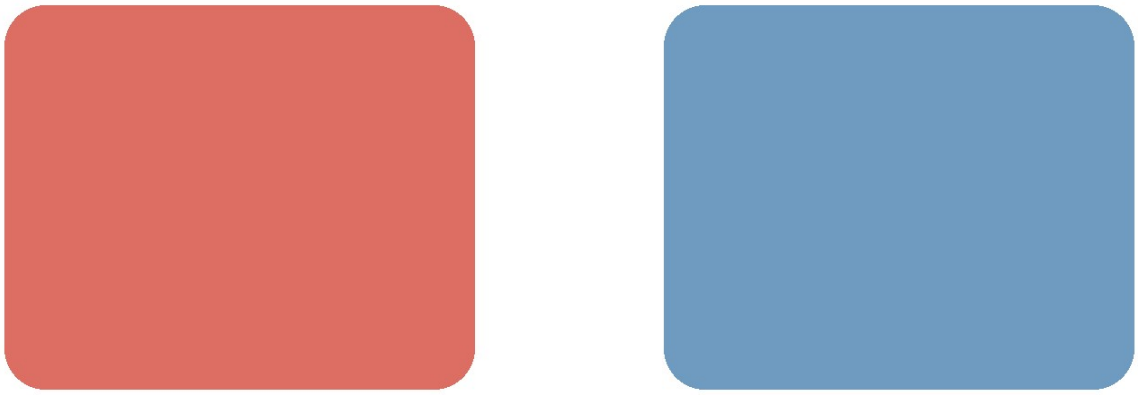
UNIT 05 COLOURS AND SIZES

Play and discover

1 Find red. Find blue. Find yellow.



2 Put a matching object on each mat.



red blue

Together Offer large red and blue objects. Model one colour match. Present size separately on the next page.

UNIT 05 AN ADULT READS ALOUD

Story and make



A red ball.



A blue cup.



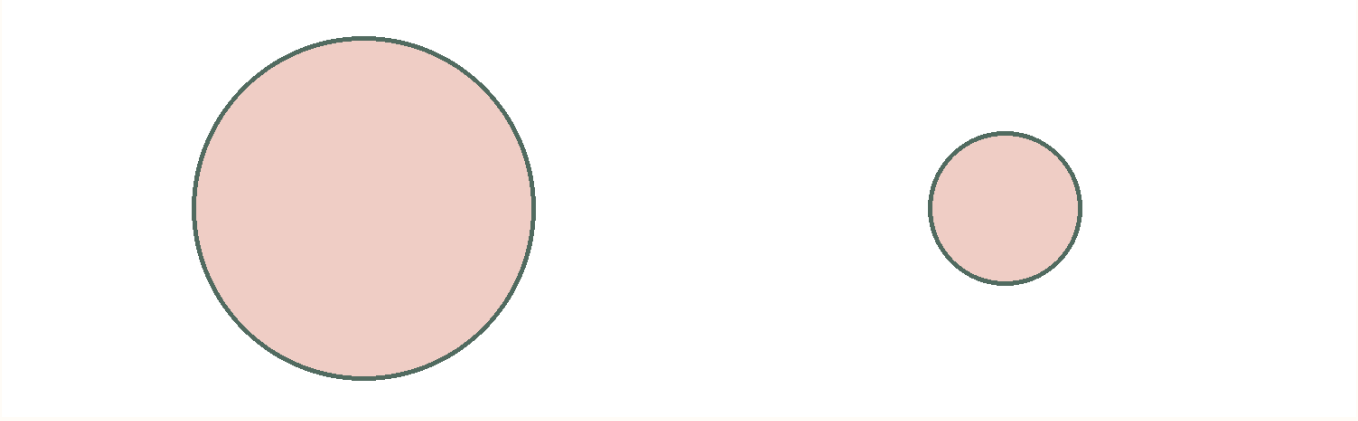
A yellow hat.

1 Find the red thing.





2 Find big. Find small.



Chant together Red and blue, I see you. / Yellow too. Hello to you.

Make marks, point or use real objects. An adult may help. Stop while the activity is enjoyable.

UNIT 06 LOOK AND LISTEN

My toys

Find the teddy. Find the box.





ball



book



bag

Put it in.

Words to model ball, teddy, book, in, out. Introduce a few at a time; labels are for shared talk.

UNIT 06 MY TOYS

Play and discover

1 Find the same toys.

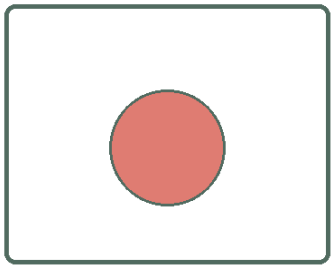








2 Put your toy in. Take it out.





in out

Together The red circle represents a ball. Use a real open box and a large ball, then compare with each picture.

UNIT 06 AN ADULT READS ALOUD

Story and make



Here is a ball.



In the bag.



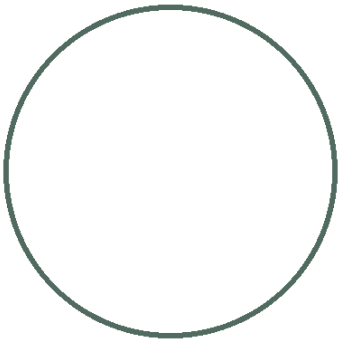
Out it comes!

1 Find the ball.





2 Colour the ball your way.



Chant together In it goes. Out it comes. / Roll the ball. Here it comes.

Make marks, point or use real objects. An adult may help. Stop while the activity is enjoyable.

UNIT 07 LOOK AND LISTEN

Food and drink

Point to the fruit. Find the cup.





apple



banana



cup

More, please.

Words to model water, apple, banana, cup, more. Introduce a few at a time; labels are for shared talk.

UNIT 07 FOOD AND DRINK

Play and discover

1 Choose your snack.



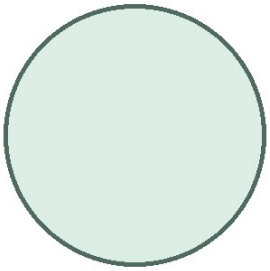
apple



banana

More, please.

2 Put one cup on the circle.



Together Use whole fruit for looking or picture cards. Put a large unbreakable cup on the space. Count one together. Offer water during the real routine.

UNIT 07 AN ADULT READS ALOUD

Story and make



An apple, please.



A cup, please.



Thank you!

1 Find the apple.





2 Put one large object on each space.

Chant together An apple. A cup. / Thank you. Tidy up.

Make marks, point or use real objects. An adult may help. Stop while the activity is enjoyable.

UNIT 08 LOOK AND LISTEN

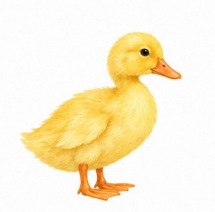
Animals around me

Find the duck. Find the bird.





cat



duck



bird

A duck can walk.

Words to model cat, dog, duck, bird. Introduce a few at a time; labels are for shared talk.

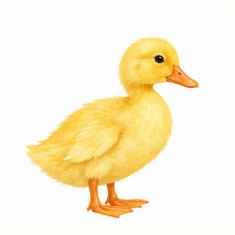
UNIT 08 ANIMALS AROUND ME

Play and discover

1 Find the same animals.









2 Move or make a sound.



dog



bird

Together Point to or name an animal. Invite a bark, a wing movement or a seated action. Stop when the child wishes.

UNIT 08 AN ADULT READS ALOUD

Story and make



Here is a duck.



Walk, little duck.



Here is a bird.

1 Find the duck.





2 Make a path for the duck.

Chant together Little duck, walk with me. / Little bird, up in the tree.

Make marks, point or use real objects. An adult may help. Stop while the activity is enjoyable.

UNIT 09 LOOK AND LISTEN

Getting ready

Find the shoes. Find the hat.





sock



shoe



hat

My hat.

Words to model shoes, socks, hat, wash, dry. Introduce a few at a time; labels are for shared talk.

Play and discover

1 Find the matching socks.





2 Find the hat. Try on a real hat.




hat shoe

My hat.

Together Invite one dressing step with clean clothes. During handwashing, model wash and dry. Never require a child to wear an item.

UNIT 09 AN ADULT READS ALOUD

Story and make



My sock.



My shoe.



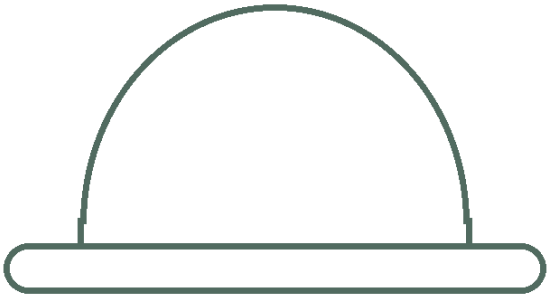
Ready to go!

1 Find the shoe.





2 Decorate the hat.



Chant together Socks and shoes. Hat on too. / Ready, ready. Me and you.

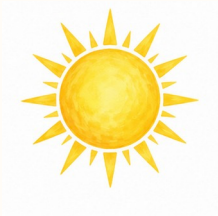
Make marks, point or use real objects. An adult may help. Stop while the activity is enjoyable.

UNIT 10 LOOK AND LISTEN

Nature around me

Find the tree. Find the flower.





sun



tree



flower

Water the plant.

Words to model sun, rain, tree, flower, water. Introduce a few at a time; labels are for shared talk.

UNIT 10 NATURE AROUND ME

Play and discover

1 Look outside. Choose a picture.



sun



rain

2 Help water a plant.



Together Use a safe plant and a little water with an adult. Show how to wipe a spill and return the jug.

UNIT 10 AN ADULT READS ALOUD

Story and make



Hello, little flower.



Here comes the rain.



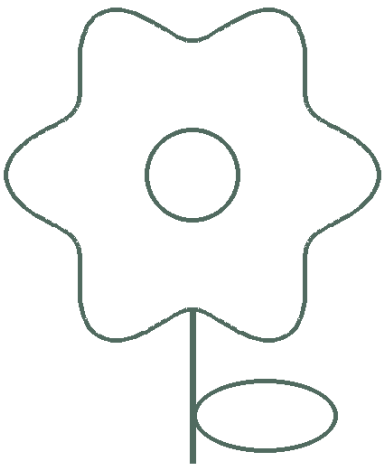
Grow, little flower.

1 Find the flower.





2 Colour the flower your way.



Chant together Sun and water. Watch it grow. / Hello, flower. Hello, hello.

Make marks, point or use real objects. An adult may help. Stop while the activity is enjoyable.

PICTURE CARDS ADULT PREPARATION

My everyday things

Point, choose and match

Print twice for identical pairs. Adults cut on the borders. Offer only two cards at first. Keep loose pieces away from children who mouth objects.

 ball	 book
 cup	 spoon
 hat	 shoe
 sock	 bag

Use real objects before pictures. These words are for adult modelling; children do not need to read them.

PICTURE CARDS ADULT PREPARATION

Animals and nature

Point, choose and match

Print twice for identical pairs. Adults cut on the borders. Offer only two cards at first. Keep loose pieces away from children who mouth objects.

 cat	 dog
 duck	 bird
 sun	 rain
 tree	 flower

Use real objects before pictures. These words are for adult modelling; children do not need to read them.

PICTURE CARDS ADULT PREPARATION

People and actions

Point, choose and match

Print twice for identical pairs. Adults cut on the borders. Offer only two cards at first. Keep loose pieces away from children who mouth objects.

 happy	 sad
 tired	 hello
 family	 girl
 boy	 clap

Use real objects before pictures. These words are for adult modelling; children do not need to read them.

PICTURE CARDS ADULT PREPARATION

Food and familiar things

Point, choose and match

Print twice for identical pairs. Adults cut on the borders. Offer only two cards at first. Keep loose pieces away from children who mouth objects.

 apple	 banana
 orange	 cup
 chair	 house
 leaf	 hand

Use real objects before pictures. These words are for adult modelling; children do not need to read them.

ADULT GUIDE UNITS 1 TO 5

Teaching through play

01 Hello and my needs

Greet the puppet. Offer a ball or a book. Pause for a look, a point or a word.

Say Hello! Yes. No. Help, please.

At home Wave hello to someone at home. Offer a choice and wait.

02 Me and my family

Invite the child to choose a family photograph. Name familiar people and match it to an identical copy.

Say This is me. Mummy. Daddy. Baby.

At home Look at a family photo. Use the names your child knows.

03 My body can move

Show one movement slowly. Invite a turn, then stop together. Seated clapping, waving or tapping are equally welcome.

Say Clap. Walk. Stop. Touch your nose.

At home Clap together. Pause. Wait for your child to start again.

04 My feelings

Let a puppet need a rest. Offer a cushion. Model a help request, then let the child choose how to respond.

Say Happy. Sad. Tired. I need help.

At home Name a feeling gently during a real moment. Offer help.

05 Colours and sizes

Present two large red objects and two large blue objects. Match one colour at a time. Compare two sizes in a separate turn.

Say Red. Blue. Yellow. Big. Small.

At home Find two things of the same colour.

Revisit the same words in daily routines. Offer fewer choices for support. Add one familiar word or action when the child is ready.

Teaching through play

06 My toys

Model putting a large toy into an open box. Take it out. Offer a turn and leave the box open for independent repetition.

Say A ball. A teddy. In. Out.

At home Put a favourite large toy in a basket, then take it out.

07 Food and drink

Offer whole fruit to look at or large picture cards. Let the child make a choice. Set one cup on a tray and count it together.

Say Water, please. More, please. Thank you.

At home Offer a choice at snack time. Model one short request.

08 Animals around me

Offer two large animal models or cards. Name one and let the child choose it. Imitate a movement or sound together.

Say A cat. A dog. A duck. A bird.

At home Find an animal in a picture book. Copy a sound or movement.

09 Getting ready

Offer two clean matching socks and one different item. Match the socks. Invite one dressing step, then wash and dry hands together.

Say My socks. My shoes. My hat. Wash. Dry.

At home Name one item while getting dressed. Give time to help.

10 Nature around me

Look outside together. Offer a safe plant, a small jug and a cloth. Help pour a little water and wipe any spill.

Say Sun. Rain. A tree. A flower. Water.

At home Look outside and name something you can see.

Revisit the same words in daily routines. Offer fewer choices for support. Add one familiar word or action when the child is ready.

Answer guidance

Unit	Story page	Picture to choose
1	7	ball
2	10	family
3	13	clap
4	16	tired
5	19	ball
6	22	ball
7	25	apple
8	28	duck
9	31	shoe
10	34	flower

Matching

Join or point to identical pictures. Unit 2 family task: first and third pictures match. Unit 9 socks task: first and third pictures match.

Colours and sizes

Match red to red and blue to blue. On page 19, the left circle is big and the right circle is small.

Counting and position

On page 24, place one cup on the one space. On page 25, place one object on each of the three spaces and count together. On page 21, the left ball is in; the right ball is out.

Personal responses

Family pictures, feelings, weather choices, colouring and creative marks vary. Accept a sensible response. Gesture, pointing and supported participation are valid.

For a factual mismatch, model gently and offer another turn. Use observation and conversation, not a score.

FOR THE ADULT NOTICE SMALL STEPS

My observation record

Child _____ Date _____

Unit	What to notice	Date and example
1	Responds to a greeting or asks for help using a gesture or word.	
2	Points to a familiar person in a photo or responds to their name.	
3	Joins a movement or responds to a familiar action instruction.	
4	Recognises a feeling picture or communicates a need for comfort.	
5	Matches a colour or chooses between two noticeably different sizes.	
6	Responds to in or out during familiar toy play.	
7	Chooses a named food or drink and attempts a request.	
8	Chooses a named animal or joins an animal sound or movement.	
9	Matches a familiar clothing item or participates in a care routine.	
10	Points to a nature picture or participates in caring for a plant.	

How the child responded

Record an exact word, gesture or action. Note whether it was modelled, supported or independent. An empty space means not observed yet.

A favourite activity _____

A gentle next step _____

This is a teaching record, not a developmental screening tool or an entry test.

My learning celebration



This celebrates

_____

for exploring English through play
and sharing ideas in their own way.

Date _____ Adult _____

Prepared by: Ms. Amina Qatan

2026

English in everyday moments

Use a familiar word in a real moment. Wait, listen and respond. Enjoy the child's interests and keep using the home language too.

When we meet

Hello!

When we need something

Help, please.

When we play

Put it in.

When we have a snack

More, please.

When we finish

Thank you. Bye!

Sources for adult planning

NAEYC Nurturing infants and toddlers with diverse language experiences

British Council How to start teaching kids English at home

American Montessori Society Core components of Montessori education

Original stories and chants prepared for this booklet. Illustrations created for the learning materials. Print at actual size or fit to your paper; single pages are not pre-imposed for folding.